

Sport

Last-gasp goal gives Greens precious win



SIMON FARRUGIA

A late goal by Martias Garcia gave Floriana three valuable points against Marsaxlokk winning the match by the odd goal in three.

In difficult conditions due to the heavy rain that poured over the Tony Bezzina Stadium the match resulted into a interesting encounter with the points could have gone either way.

This was a tricky match for both teams with M'Xlokk trying to hold on to the top position following three consecutive wins in the first phase of the Closing Round.

On the other hand Floriana wanted the maximum points at all costs in order to keep on putting the pressure on the front pack,

STANDINGS

	P	W	D	L	F	A	Pts
Hamrun	5	3	2	0	9	2	11
Floriana	5	3	1	1	7	3	10
Sliema	5	3	0	2	11	6	9
Birkirkara	5	2	3	0	10	5	9
Hibernians	5	3	0	2	11	8	9
Marsaxlokk	5	3	0	2	9	9	9
Zabbar	5	2	0	3	5	5	6
Mosta	5	2	0	3	4	6	6
Melita	5	1	2	2	9	10	5
Gzira	5	1	2	2	6	9	5
Balzan	4	1	0	3	5	13	3
Naxxar	4	0	0	4	0	10	0

BOV CHALLENGE LEAGUE

Yesterday

Gudja-Mtarfa	3-1
Sirens-Fgura	1-2
Zurrieq-Mgarr	1-1
Marsa-Valletta	0-1



amongst them Hamrun Spartans who have had a flying start in the Closing Round.

The only match between these two sides was played in the first round of the Opening Round since the Greens made it to the Top Six and M'Xlokk had to settled for a place amongst the bottom six after a bumpy start where they lost their first five assignments. On that occasion the match ended in a 1-1 draw.

After nine minutes came the first chance of the match when Messias

received a ball in the penalty area, made his way past Mafoumbi but Zammit Lonardelli blocked his effort.

But it was Floriana who forged ahead on 15 minutes. An acute free-kick taken by Gamarra left Calleja Cremona stranded for the Greens opener.

On the hour Mafoumbi was on the alert to save on Leandro Agius. With M'Xlokk now piling on the pressure and in the 77th minute a Yuri Messias shot from the edge of the area just missing the target.

The Seasideers drew level nine minutes from the end when following a free-kick it was Lucas Lopez who drafted the ball home. And M'Xlokk could have forged ahead a few moments later but Mafoumbi made a good save on Soares.

Floriana scored the winning goal two minutes from time when off a corner Matias Garcia turned the ball into the net to the delight of the Floriana faithful.

Photos: Nicholas Falzon





FLORIANA



2

Scorers
Gamarra, Lopez, Garcia

Yellow cards
Soares, Grech, Vella

Referee
Matthew De Gabriele

Player of the match
Gonzalo Gamarra (Floriana)



MARSAXLOKK

1

M. Call. Cremona
K. Micallef
J. Soares
N. Muscat
Y. Messias
J. Corbalan
J. Arias
M. Adamec
L. Dessypris
A. De Aguiar
L. Aguirre



ZABBAR



0

L. Camilleri
J. Micallef
W. Bonilha Felix
B. Gambarte
A. Pio Iervolino
J. Pisani
D. Tavares
S. Jovancic
V. De Paiva
J. Sa Mendonca
D. Souza

HAMRUN



1

H. Bonello
S. Xerri
Essien
E. Da Silva
J. Cadenovic
R. Mihana
M. da Rocha
E. Marcelina
C. Claros
R. Camenzuli
M. Klepac

Referee: Ishmael Barbara